

MOUNTING

For a new rider, the first challenge is getting into the saddle. Learning how to mount a horse quickly and safely takes lots of practice. The rider should always begin from the left-hand or "near" side of the horse.



1 LIFT FOOT
Face the horse's rear. Hold the stirrup in the right hand and put the left foot in it.



2 HOP
Hold the front of the saddle and hop round to face forwards. Use the right arm for support.



3 SPRING
Spring up and swing the right leg over the horse's back. Land gently in the saddle.

DISMOUNTING

Getting off a horse feels easier than getting on. However, for safety and the horse's comfort, the correct technique must be used. The rider dismounts on the near side and should never attempt to jump off while the horse is moving.



1 FEET OUT
Holding the front of the saddle, take both feet out of the stirrups and lean forwards.



2 SWING
Lift the right leg and swing it carefully over the horse's back.



3 SLIDE
Slide or drop down the horse's side and land lightly, facing forwards.

**THE HIGH-JUMP
RECORD FOR
A HORSE IS 2.47 M
(8 FT 1 1/4 IN)**



JUMPING

Learning to jump on horseback is one of the biggest thrills for any rider. Most horses find it fun, too.

FOUR PACES

Horses have four main natural paces, or ways of moving at different speeds. These are walk, trot, canter, and gallop. At each pace, the horse's feet touch the ground in a repeated sequence of steps.



WALK: AVERAGE SPEED 5-6.5 KM/H (3-4 MPH)



TROT: AVERAGE SPEED 13-16 KM/H (8-10 MPH)



CANTER: AVERAGE SPEED 16-27 KM/H (10-17 MPH)



GALLOP: AVERAGE SPEED 40-48 KM/H (25-30 MPH)

HORSE SPORTS

Games and sports with horses are popular worldwide. They include racing, team games, and competitions between individual riders, such as jumping and cross-country events.



POLO

Team game in which riders strike a ball with mallets.



STEEPLECHASE

Race over obstacles such as fences and ditches.



DRESSAGE

Competition to show how well a horse moves.



EVENTING

Sport combining dressage, cross-country riding, and showjumping.



HARNESS RACE

Racing with two-wheeled carts called sulkies.



HORSEBALL

Team game in which riders shoot a ball into a net.



RODEO

Contest based on traditional cowboy skills.